

Equal Groups and Fair Shares



Grade 3 • Mathematics
NC.3.OA.3

Connect equal groups, multiplication, and division.



What will a strong explanation show?

1. A model or equation that fits the quantities.
2. Accurate calculation with appropriate units.
3. A check that makes the answer reasonable.



Watch the reasoning

The science club fills 3 folders with 4 cards each. How many cards are there altogether? Draw equal groups and write an equation.

$3 \times 4 = 12$; add 4 a total of 3 times.



Build a second model together

The art club places 72 cards equally into 9 folders. How many cards go in each folder? Draw a model and write an equation.

Discuss: What should the first step find?



Your turn • 1

The reading group fills 3 folders with 5 cards each. How many cards are there altogether? Draw equal groups and write an equation.

Represent → solve → explain → check



Your turn • 2

The music club places 18 cards equally into 6 folders. How many cards go in each folder? Draw a model and write an equation.

Represent → solve → explain → check



Your turn • 3

The music club fills 8 folders with 4 cards each. How many cards are there altogether? Draw equal groups and write an equation.

Represent → solve → explain → check



Your turn • 4

The library team places 49 cards equally into 7 folders. How many cards go in each folder? Draw a model and write an equation.

Represent → solve → explain → check



Exit question • Explain independently

The music club fills 2 folders with 7 cards each. How many cards are there altogether? Draw equal groups and write an equation.

Include a check. What would you teach someone else?



Teacher review and next steps

1. 15

Exit: 14

2. 3

Use the worked PDF key and slide notes to discuss methods. Revisit the earliest unclear step before adding more practice.

3. 32

4. 7

